

Acts

15:5 But some **believers** from the **party** of the **Pharisees** stood up and declared, "The Gentiles must be circumcised and **required to obey** the law of Moses." ⁶ So the apostles and elders **met** to **look** into this **matter**.

⁷ After **much discussion**, **Peter** got up and said to them, "Brothers, you know that in the **early** days God made a **choice** among you that the Gentiles would hear from my **lips** the **message** of the gospel and believe. ⁸ God, who **knows** the heart, **showed** that he **accepted** them by giving the Holy Spirit to them, just as he did to us. ⁹ He did not **discriminate between** us and them, for he **purified** their hearts by faith.

¹⁰ Now then, why do you **test** God by **placing** on the **necks** of the disciples a **yoke** that **neither** we **nor** our fathers have been able to **bear**? ¹¹ On the **contrary**, we believe it is through the grace of the Lord Jesus that we are saved, just as they are."

¹³ When they had **finished** speaking, **James** declared, "Brothers, listen to me! ¹⁹ It is my judgment, therefore, that we should not make it **difficult** for the Gentiles who are **turning to God**. ²⁰ Instead, we should **write** and tell them to **abstain** from **food** polluted by **idols**, from **sexual immorality**, from the **meat** of **strangled animals**, and from blood. ²¹ For Moses has been **proclaimed** in every city from **ancient times** and is **read** in the **synagogues** on every **Sabbath**."

²² Then the apostles and elders, with the whole church, **decided to select** men from among them to send to **Antioch** with Paul and **Barnabas**. They **chose** **Judas** called **Barsabbas** and Silas, two leaders among the brothers,

16:1 Paul came to **Derbe** and then to **Lystra**, where he found a **disciple** named Timothy, the **son** of a **believing Jewish woman** and a **Greek** father. ² The brothers in **Lystra** and **Iconium** spoke well of him. ³ Paul **wanted** Timothy to **accompany** him, so he took him and circumcised him on account of the Jews in that **area**, for they all **knew** that his father was a **Greek**.

⁴ As they went from town to town, they **delivered** the **decisions** **handed** down by the apostles and elders in Jerusalem for the people to **obey**. ⁵ So the **churches** were **strengthened** in the faith and **grew daily** in **numbers**.

¹² From there we went to the **Roman colony** of **Philippi**, the **leading** city of that **district** of **Macedonia**. And we stayed there several days. ¹³ On the **Sabbath** we went outside the city **gate** along the **river**, where it was **customary** to find a place of prayer. After **sitting** down, we spoke to the women who had **gathered** there.

¹⁴ Among those listening was a **woman** named **Lydia**, a **dealer in purple cloth** from the city of **Thyatira**, who was a **worshiper** of God. The Lord **opened** her heart to **respond** to Paul's **message**. ¹⁵ And when she and her household had been baptized, she **urged** us, "If you consider me a **believer** in the Lord, come and stay at my house." And she

persuaded us.

¹⁶ One day as we were going to the place of prayer, we were met by a slave girl with a spirit of divination, who earned a large income for her masters by fortune-telling. ¹⁷ This girl followed Paul and the rest of us, shouting, "These men are servants of the Most High God, who are proclaiming to you the way of salvation!" ¹⁸ She continued this for many days. Eventually Paul grew so aggravated that he turned and said to the spirit, "In the name of Jesus Christ I command you to come out of her!" And the spirit left her at that very moment.

¹⁹ When the girl's owners saw that their hope of making money was gone, they seized Paul and Silas and dragged them before the authorities in the marketplace. ²⁰ They brought them to the magistrates and said, "These men are Jews and are throwing our city into turmoil ²¹ by promoting customs that are unlawful for us Romans to adopt or practice."

²² The crowd joined in the attack against Paul and Silas, and the magistrates ordered that they be stripped and beaten with rods. ²³ And after striking them with many blows, they threw them into prison and ordered the jailer to guard them securely. ²⁴ On receiving this order, he placed them in the inner cell and fastened their feet in the stocks.

²⁵ About midnight Paul and Silas were praying and singing hymns to God, and the other prisoners were listening to them. ²⁶ Suddenly a strong earthquake shook the foundations of the prison. At once all the doors flew open and everyone's chains came loose.

²⁷ When the jailer woke up and saw the prison doors open, he drew his sword and was about to kill himself, presuming that the prisoners had escaped. ²⁸ But Paul called out in a loud voice, "Do not harm yourself! We are all here!"

²⁹ Calling for lights, the jailer rushed in and fell trembling before Paul and Silas. ³⁰ Then he brought them out and asked, "Sirs, what must I do to be saved?"

³¹ They replied, "Believe in the Lord Jesus, and you will be saved — you and your household." ³² Then they spoke the word of the Lord to him and to all the others in his house. ³³ At that hour of the night, the jailer took them and washed their wounds. And without delay, he and all his household were baptized. ³⁴ Then he brought them into his home and set a meal before them. So he and all his household rejoiced that they had come to believe in God.

17:22 Then Paul stood up in the meeting of the Areopagus and said, "Men of Athens, I see that in every way you are very religious. ²⁴ The God who made the world and everything in it is the Lord of heaven and earth and does not live in temples built by human hands. ²⁵ And he is not served by human hands, as if he needed anything. Rather, he himself gives everyone life and breath and everything else. ²⁶ From one man He made every nation of men, that they should inhabit the whole earth; and He determined their appointed times and the boundaries of their lands.

²⁷ God did this so that they would seek Him and perhaps reach out for Him and find Him, though He is not far from any one of us. ²⁸ 'For in Him we live and move and have our being.' As some of your own poets have said, 'We are His offspring.'

²⁹ Therefore, being offspring of God, we should not think that the Divine Being is like gold or silver or stone, an image formed by man's skill and imagination. ³⁰ Although God overlooked the ignorance of earlier times, He now commands all people everywhere to repent. ³¹ For He has set a day when He will judge the world with justice by the Man He has appointed. He has given proof of this to everyone by raising Him from the dead."

Month 2

18:1 After this, Paul left Athens and went to Corinth. ² There he found a Jew named Aquila, a native of Pontus, who had recently come from Italy with his wife Priscilla because Claudius had ordered all the Jews to leave Rome. Paul went to visit them, ³ and he stayed and worked with them because they were tentmakers by trade, just as he was.

⁹ One night the Lord spoke to Paul in a vision: "Do not be afraid; keep on speaking, do not be silent. ¹⁰ For I am with you, and no one is going to attack and harm you, because I have many people in this city." ¹¹ So Paul stayed for a year and a half, teaching the word of God among the Corinthians.

²⁴ Meanwhile a Jew named Apollos, a native of Alexandria, came to Ephesus. He was an eloquent man, well versed in the Scriptures. ²⁵ He had been instructed in the way of the Lord and was fervent in spirit. He spoke and taught accurately about Jesus, though he knew only the baptism of John. ²⁶ And he began to speak boldly in the synagogue. When Priscilla and Aquila heard him, they took him aside and explained to him the way of God more accurately.

²⁷ When Apollos resolved to cross over to Achaia, the brothers encouraged him and wrote to the disciples there to welcome him. On his arrival, he was a great help to those who by grace had believed. ²⁸ For he powerfully refuted the Jews in public debate, proving from the Scriptures that Jesus is the Christ.

19:1 While Apollos was at Corinth, Paul passed through the interior and came to Ephesus. There he found some disciples ² and asked them, "Did you receive the Holy Spirit when you became believers?"

"No," they answered, "we have not even heard that there is a Holy Spirit."

³ "Into what, then, were you baptized?" Paul asked.

"The baptism of John," they replied.

⁴ Paul said, "John's baptism was a baptism of repentance. He told the people to believe in the one coming after him, that is, in Jesus."

⁵ On hearing this, they were baptized into the name of the Lord Jesus. ⁶ And when Paul **laid** his hands on them, the Holy Spirit came upon them, and they spoke in **tongues** and **prophesied**. ⁷ There were about **twelve** men in all.

⁸ Then Paul went into the synagogue and spoke boldly there for three **months**, **arguing** **persuasively** about the kingdom of God. ⁹ But when some of them **stubbornly refused** to believe and **publicly maligned** the Way, Paul took his disciples and left the synagogue to **conduct** **daily** **discussions** in the **lecture hall** of **Tyrannus**. ¹⁰ This **continued** for two years, so that everyone who **lived** in the province of Asia, Jews and Greeks **alike**, heard the word of the Lord.

¹¹ God did **extraordinary** **miracles** through the hands of Paul, ¹² so that even **handkerchiefs** and **aprons** that had **touched** him were taken to the **sick**, and the **diseases** and evil **spirits** left them.

20:17 From **Miletus**, Paul sent to Ephesus for the elders of the church.

¹⁸ When they came to him, he said, “You know how I **lived** the whole time I was with you, from the **first** day I **arrived** in the province of Asia. ¹⁹ I served the Lord with great **humility** and with tears, especially in the **trials** that came upon me through the **plots** of the Jews. ²⁰ I did not **shrink** back from **declaring** anything that was **helpful** to you as I taught you **publicly** and from house to house, ²¹ testifying to Jews and Greeks **alike** about **repentance** to God and faith in our Lord Jesus Christ.

²² And now, **compelled** by the Spirit, I am going to Jerusalem, not knowing what will **happen** to me there. ²³ I only know that in town after town the Holy Spirit **warns** me that chains and **afflictions** **await** me. ²⁴ However, I consider my life worth nothing to me; my only aim is to finish the race and complete the task the Lord Jesus has given me—the task of testifying to the good news of God’s grace.

²⁵ Now I know that **none** of you among whom I have **preached** the kingdom will see my **face** again. ²⁶ Therefore I **testify** to you this day that I am **innocent** of the blood of all men. ²⁷ For I did not **shrink** back from **declaring** to you the whole will of God.

²⁸ Keep **watch** over yourselves and the **entire** **flock** of which the Holy Spirit has made you **overseers**. Be **shepherds** of the church of God, which He **purchased** with His own blood. ²⁹ I know that after I leave, **savage** **wolves** will come in among you and will not **spare** the **flock**. ³⁰ Even from your own **number** men will **arise** and **distort** the truth in order to **draw** away disciples after them. ³¹ Therefore be **alert** and **remember** that for three years I never **stopped** **warning** each of you night and day with tears.

³² Now I **commit** you to God and to the word of his grace, which can **build** you up and **give** you an **inheritance** among all those who are **sanctified**.

³³ I have not **coveted** **anyone’s** **silver** or **gold** or **clothing**. ³⁴ You yourselves know that these hands of **mine** have **ministered** to my own needs and those of my companions.

³⁵ In everything I did, I **showed** you that by this **kind** of **hard** work we must help the

weak, remembering the words the Lord Jesus himself said: 'It is more blessed to give than to receive.

³⁶ When Paul had said this, he knelt down with all of them and prayed. ³⁷ They all wept openly as they embraced Paul and kissed him. ³⁸ They were especially grieved by his statement that they would never see his face again. Then they accompanied him to the ship.

Month 3

21:8 Leaving the next day, we went on to Caesarea and stayed at the home of Philip the evangelist, who was one of the Seven. ⁹ He had four unmarried daughters who prophesied.

¹⁰ After we had been there several days, a prophet named Agabus came down from Judea. ¹¹ Coming over to us, he took Paul's belt, bound his own feet and hands, and said, "The Holy Spirit says: 'In this way the Jews of Jerusalem will bind the owner of this belt and hand him over to the Gentiles.'"

¹² When we heard this, we and the people there pleaded with Paul not to go up to Jerusalem.

¹³ Then Paul answered, "Why are you weeping and breaking my heart? I am ready not only to be bound, but also to die in Jerusalem for the name of the Lord Jesus." ¹⁴ When he would not be dissuaded, we quieted down and said, "The Lord's will be done."

¹⁵ After these days, we packed up and went on to Jerusalem.

²⁷ When the seven days were almost over, some Jews from the province of Asia saw Paul at the temple. They stirred up the whole crowd and seized him, ²⁸ crying out, "Men of Israel, help us! This is the man who teaches everyone everywhere against our people and against our law and against this place. Furthermore, he has brought Greeks into the temple and defiled this holy place." ²⁹ For they had previously seen Trophimus the Ephesian with him in the city, and they assumed that Paul had brought him into the temple.

³⁴ Some in the crowd were shouting one thing, and some another. And since the commander could not get at the truth because of the uproar, he ordered that Paul be brought into the barracks. ⁴⁰ Having received permission, Paul stood on the steps and motioned to the crowd. A great hush came over the crowd, and he addressed them in Hebrew:

22:1 "Brothers and fathers, listen now to my defense before you."

² When they heard him speak to them in Hebrew, they became even more quiet. Then Paul declared, ³ "I am a Jew, born in Tarsus of Cilicia, but raised in this city. I was educated at the feet of Gamaliel in strict conformity to the law of our fathers. I was

just as zealous for God as any of you are today.

⁴ I persecuted this Way even to the death, detaining both men and women and throwing them into prison, ⁵ as the high priest and the whole Council can testify about me. I even obtained letters from them to their brothers in Damascus, and I was on my way to apprehend these people and bring them to Jerusalem to be punished.

⁶ About noon as I was approaching Damascus, suddenly a bright light from heaven flashed around me. ⁷ I fell to the ground and heard a voice say to me, 'Saul, Saul, why do you persecute Me?'

⁸ 'Who are You, Lord?' I asked. i

'I am Jesus of Nazareth, whom you are persecuting,' He replied. ⁹ My companions saw the light, but they could not understand the voice of the One speaking to me.

¹⁰ Then I asked, 'What should I do, Lord?'

'Get up and go into Damascus,' He told me. 'There you will be told all that you have been appointed to do.'

¹¹ Because the brilliance of the light had blinded me, my companions led me by the hand into Damascus. ¹² There a man named Ananias, a devout observer of the law who was highly regarded by all the Jews living there, ¹³ came and stood beside me. 'Brother Saul,' he said, 'receive your sight.' And at that moment I could see him.

¹⁴ Then he said: 'The God of our ancestors has chosen you to know his will and to see the Righteous One and to hear words from his mouth. ¹⁵ You will be his witness to all people of what you have seen and heard. ¹⁶ And now what are you waiting for? Get up, be baptized, and wash your sins away, calling on His name.'

¹⁷ Later, when I had returned to Jerusalem and was praying at the temple, I fell into a trance ¹⁸ and saw the Lord saying to me, 'Hurry! Leave Jerusalem quickly, because the people here will not accept your testimony about Me.'

¹⁹ 'Lord,' I answered, 'they know very well that in one synagogue after another I imprisoned and beat those who believed in You. ²⁰ And when the blood of Your witness Stephen was shed, I stood there giving my approval and watching over the garments of those who killed him.'

²¹ Then He said to me, 'Go! I will send you far away to the Gentiles.'"

Month 4

24:22 Then Felix, who was well informed about the Way, adjourned the hearing and said, "When Lysias the commander comes, I will decide your case." ²³ He ordered the centurion to keep Paul under guard, but to allow him some freedom and permit his friends to minister to his needs.

²⁴ After several days, Felix returned with his wife Drusilla, who was a Jewess. He sent for Paul and listened to him speak about faith in Christ Jesus. ²⁵ As Paul expounded on righteousness, self-control, and the coming judgment, Felix became frightened and said, "You may go for now. When I find the time, I will call for you." ²⁶ At the same time, he was hoping that Paul would offer him a bribe. So he sent for Paul frequently and talked with him.

²⁷ After two years had passed, Felix was succeeded by Porcius Festus. And wishing to do the Jews a favor, Felix left Paul in prison.

25:9 But Festus, wishing to do the Jews a favor, said to Paul, "Are you willing to go up to Jerusalem to stand trial before me on these charges?"

¹⁰ Paul replied, "I am standing before the judgment seat of Caesar, where I ought to be tried. I have done nothing wrong to the Jews, as you yourself know very well. ¹¹ If, however, I am guilty of anything worthy of death, I do not refuse to die. But if there is no truth to their accusations against me, no one has the right to hand me over to them. I appeal to Caesar!"

¹² Then Festus conferred with his council and replied, "You have appealed to Caesar. To Caesar you will go!"

26:24 At this stage of Paul's defense, Festus exclaimed in a loud voice, "You are insane, Paul! Your great learning is driving you to madness!"

²⁵ "I am not insane, most excellent Festus," Paul replied. "What I am saying is true and reasonable. ²⁶ For the king knows about these matters, and I can speak freely to him. I am confident that none of this has escaped his notice, because it was not done in a corner. ²⁷ King Agrippa, do you believe the prophets? I know you do."

²⁸ Then Agrippa said to Paul, "Can you persuade me in such a short time to become a Christian?"

²⁹ Paul replied, "Short time or long—I pray to God that not only you but all who are listening to me today may become what I am, except for these chains."

³⁰ Then the king and the governor rose, along with Bernice and those seated with them. ³¹ On their way out, they said to one another, "This man has done nothing worthy of death or imprisonment."

³² And Agrippa said to Festus, "This man could have been released if he had not appealed to Caesar."

28:16 When we arrived in Rome, Paul was permitted to stay by himself, with a soldier to guard him.

¹⁷ After three days, he called together the leaders of the Jews. When they had gathered, he said to them, "Brothers, although I have done nothing against our people or the customs of our fathers, I was taken prisoner in Jerusalem and handed over to

the Romans. ¹⁸ They examined me and wanted to release me, because there was no basis for a death sentence against me. ¹⁹ But when the Jews objected, I was compelled to appeal to Caesar, even though I have no charge to bring against my nation. ²⁰ So for this reason I have called to see you and speak with you. It is because of the hope of Israel that I am bound with this chain."

²¹ The leaders replied, "We have not received any letters about you from Judea, nor have any of the brothers from there reported or even mentioned anything bad about you. ²² But we consider your views worth hearing, because we know that people everywhere are speaking against this sect."

²³ So they set a day to meet with Paul, and many people came to the place he was staying. He expounded to them from morning to evening, testifying about the kingdom of God and persuading them about Jesus from the Law of Moses and the Prophets.

²⁴ Some of them were convinced by what he said, but others refused to believe. ²⁵ They disagreed among themselves and began to leave after Paul had made this final statement: "The Holy Spirit was right when He spoke to your fathers through Isaiah the prophet:

²⁶ 'Go to this people and say, "You will be ever hearing but never understanding; you will be ever seeing but never perceiving."

²⁷ For this people's heart has grown callous; they hardly hear with their ears, and they have closed their eyes. Otherwise they might see with their eyes, hear with their ears, understand with their hearts, and turn, and I would heal them.'

²⁸ Therefore I want you to know that God's salvation has been sent to the Gentiles, and they will listen!"

³⁰ Paul stayed there two full years in his own rented house, welcoming all who came to visit him. ³¹ Boldly and freely he proclaimed the kingdom of God and taught about the Lord Jesus Christ.

Month 5

Philippians

1:1 Paul and Timothy, servants of Christ Jesus, To all the saints in Christ Jesus at Philippi, together with the overseers and deacons:

² Grace and peace to you from God our Father and the Lord Jesus Christ.

³ I thank my God every time I remember you. ⁴ In all my prayers for all of you, I always pray with joy ⁵ because of your partnership in the gospel from the first day until now, ⁶ being confident of this, that he who began a good work in you will carry it

on to completion until the day of Christ Jesus.

⁷ It is right for me to feel this way about all of you, since I have you in my heart. For in my chains and in my defense and confirmation of the gospel, you are all partners in grace with me. ⁸ God is my witness how I long for all of you with the affection of Christ Jesus.

⁹ And this is my prayer: that your love may abound more and more in knowledge and depth of insight, ¹⁰ so that you may be able to test and prove what is best and may be pure and blameless for the day of Christ, ¹¹ filled with the fruit of righteousness that comes through Jesus Christ, to the glory and praise of God.

¹² Now I want you to know, brothers, that my circumstances have actually served to advance the gospel. ¹³ As a result, it has become clear throughout the whole palace guard and to everyone else that I am in chains for Christ. ¹⁴ And most of the brothers, confident in the Lord by my chains, now dare more greatly to speak the word without fear.

¹⁵ It is true that some preach Christ out of envy and rivalry, but others out of goodwill. ¹⁶ The latter do so in love, knowing that I am appointed for the defense of the gospel. ¹⁷ The former, however, preach Christ out of selfish ambition, not sincerely, supposing that they can add to the distress of my chains.

¹⁸ What then is the issue? Just this: that in every way, whether by false motives or true, Christ is preached. And in this I rejoice. Yes, and I will continue to rejoice, ¹⁹ because I know that through your prayers and the provision of the Spirit of Jesus Christ, my distress will turn out for my deliverance. ²⁰ I eagerly expect and hope that I will in no way be ashamed, but will have complete boldness so that now as always Christ will be exalted in my body, whether by life or by death.

²¹ For to me, to live is Christ and to die is gain. ²² But if I go on living in the body, this will mean fruitful labor for me. So what shall I choose? I do not know. ²³ I am torn between the two. I desire to depart and be with Christ, which is far better indeed. ²⁴ But it is more necessary for you that I remain in the body.

²⁵ Convinced of this, I know that I will remain and will continue with all of you for your progress and joy in the faith, ²⁶ so that through my coming to you again your exultation in Christ Jesus will resound on account of me.

²⁷ Nevertheless, conduct yourselves in a manner worthy of the gospel of Christ. Then, whether I come and see you or only hear about you in my absence, I will know that you stand firm in one spirit, contending together as one for the faith of the gospel, ²⁸ without being frightened in any way by those who oppose you. This is a clear sign of their destruction but of your salvation, and it is from God. ²⁹ For it has been granted to you on behalf of Christ not only to believe in Him, but also to suffer for Him, ³⁰ since you are encountering the same struggle you saw I had, and now hear that I still have.

2:1 Therefore if you have any encouragement in Christ, if any comfort from His love, if any fellowship with the Spirit, if any affection and compassion, ² then make my joy complete by being like-minded, having the same love, being united in spirit and purpose.

³ Do nothing out of selfish ambition or vain conceit. Rather, in humility value others above yourselves, ⁴ not looking to your own interests but each of you to the interests of the others.

⁵ Let this mind be in you which was also in Christ Jesus:

⁶ Who, existing in the form of God, did not consider equality with God something to be grasped,

⁷ but emptied Himself, taking the form of a servant, being made in human likeness.

⁸ And being found in appearance as a man, He humbled Himself and became obedient to death—even death on a cross.

⁹ Therefore God exalted Him to the highest place and gave Him the name above all names,

¹⁰ that at the name of Jesus every knee should bow, in heaven and on earth and under the earth,

¹¹ and every tongue confess that Jesus Christ is Lord, to the glory of God the Father.

Month 6

¹² Therefore, my beloved, just as you have always obeyed, not only in my presence, but now even more in my absence, continue to work out your salvation with fear and trembling. ¹³ For it is God who works in you to will and to act on behalf of His good purpose.

¹⁴ Do everything without complaining or arguing, ¹⁵ so that you may be blameless and pure, children of God without fault in a crooked and perverse generation, in which you shine as lights in the world ¹⁶ as you hold forth the word of life, in order that I may boast on the day of Christ that I did not run or labor in vain.

¹⁷ But even if I am being poured out like a drink offering on the sacrifice and service of your faith, I am glad and rejoice with all of you. ¹⁸ So you too should be glad and rejoice with me.

¹⁹ Now I hope in the Lord Jesus to send Timothy to you soon, that I also may be cheered when I learn how you are doing. ²⁰ I have nobody else like him who will genuinely care for your needs. ²¹ For all the others look after their own interests, not those of Jesus Christ. ²² But you know Timothy's proven worth, that as a child with his father he has served with me to advance the gospel. ²³ So I hope to send him as

soon as I see what happens with me. ²⁴ And I trust in the Lord that I myself will come soon.

²⁵ But I thought it necessary to send back to you Epaphroditus, my brother, fellow worker, and fellow soldier, who is also your messenger and minister to my needs. ²⁶ For he has been longing for all of you and is distressed because you heard he was ill. ²⁷ He was sick indeed, nearly unto death. But God had mercy on him, and not only on him but also on me, to spare me sorrow upon sorrow.

²⁸ Therefore I am all the more eager to send him, so that when you see him again you may rejoice, and I may be less anxious. ²⁹ Welcome him in the Lord with great joy, and honor men like him, ³⁰ because he nearly died for the work of Christ, risking his life to make up for your deficit of service to me.

3:1 Finally, my brothers, rejoice in the Lord. It is no trouble for me to write the same things to you again, and it is a safeguard for you.

² Watch out for those dogs, those workers of evil, those mutilators of the flesh! ³ For it is we who are the circumcision, we who worship by the Spirit of God, who glory in Christ Jesus, and who put no confidence in the flesh— ⁴ though I myself could have such confidence.

If anyone else thinks he has grounds for confidence in the flesh, I have more: ⁵ circumcised on the eighth day, of the people of Israel, of the tribe of Benjamin; a Hebrew of Hebrews; as to the law, a Pharisee; ⁶ as to zeal, persecuting the church; as to righteousness in the law, faultless.

⁷ But whatever was gain to me I count as loss for the sake of Christ. ⁸ More than that, I count all things as loss compared to the surpassing excellence of knowing Christ Jesus my Lord, for whom I have lost all things. I consider them rubbish, that I may gain Christ ⁹ and be found in Him, not having my own righteousness from the law, but that which is through faith in Christ, the righteousness from God on the basis of faith.

¹⁰ I want to know Christ—yes, to know the power of his resurrection and participation in his sufferings, becoming like him in his death, ¹¹ and so, somehow, attaining to the resurrection from the dead.

¹² Not that I have already obtained all this, or have already been made perfect, but I press on to take hold of that for which Christ Jesus took hold of me. ¹³ Brothers, I do not consider myself yet to have taken hold of it. But one thing I do: Forgetting what is behind and straining toward what is ahead, ¹⁴ I press on toward the goal to win the prize of God's heavenly calling in Christ Jesus.

¹⁵ All of us who are mature should embrace this point of view. And if you think differently about some issue, God will reveal this to you as well. ¹⁶ Nevertheless, we must live up to what we have already attained.

¹⁷ Join one another in following my example, brothers, and carefully observe those

who walk according to the pattern we set for you. ¹⁸ For as I have often told you before, and now say again even with tears: Many live as enemies of the cross of Christ. ¹⁹ Their end is destruction, their god is their belly, and their glory is in their shame. Their minds are set on earthly things.

²⁰ But our citizenship is in heaven, and we eagerly await a Savior from there, the Lord Jesus Christ, ²¹ who, by the power that enables Him to subject all things to Himself, will transform our lowly bodies to be like His glorious body.

Month 7

4:1 Therefore, my brothers, whom I love and long for, my joy and crown, that is how you must stand firm in the Lord, my beloved.

² I urge Euodia and Syntyche to agree with each other in the Lord. ³ Yes, and I ask you, my true yokefellow, to help these women who have contended at my side for the gospel, along with Clement and the rest of my fellow workers, whose names are in the Book of Life. ⁴ Rejoice in the Lord always. I will say it again: Rejoice! ⁵ Let your gentleness be evident to all. The Lord is near.

⁶ Do not be anxious about anything, but in every situation, by prayer and petition, with thanksgiving, present your requests to God. ⁷ And the peace of God, which transcends all understanding, will guard your hearts and your minds in Christ Jesus.

⁸ Finally, brothers and sisters, whatever is true, whatever is noble, whatever is right, whatever is pure, whatever is lovely, whatever is admirable—if anything is excellent or praiseworthy—think about such things. ⁹ Whatever you have learned or received or heard from me, or seen in me, put it into practice. And the God of peace will be with you.

¹⁰ Now I rejoice greatly in the Lord that at last you have revived your concern for me. You were indeed concerned, but you had no opportunity to show it. ¹¹ I am not saying this out of need, for I have learned to be content regardless of my circumstances. ¹² I know what it is to be in need, and I know what it is to have plenty. I have learned the secret of being content in any and every situation, whether well fed or hungry, whether living in plenty or in want. ¹³ I can do all this through him who gives me strength.

¹⁴ Nevertheless, you have done well to share in my affliction. ¹⁵ And as you Philippians know, in the early days of the gospel, when I left Macedonia, no church but you partnered with me in the matter of giving and receiving. ¹⁶ For even while I was in Thessalonica, you provided for my needs again and again.

¹⁷ Not that I am seeking a gift, but I am looking for the fruit that may be credited to your account. ¹⁸ I have all I need and more, now that I have received your gifts from Epaphroditus. They are a fragrant offering, an acceptable sacrifice, well-pleasing to God.

¹⁹ And my God will supply all your needs according to His glorious riches in Christ Jesus. ²⁰ To our God and Father be glory forever and ever. Amen.

²¹ Greet all the saints in Christ Jesus. The brothers who are with me send you greetings.

²² All the saints send you greetings, especially those from the household of Caesar.

²³ The grace of the Lord Jesus Christ be with your spirit.

Ephesians

6:10 Finally, be strong in the Lord and in His mighty power. ¹¹ Put on the full armor of God, so that you can make your stand against the devil's schemes. ¹² For our struggle is not against flesh and blood, but against the rulers, against the authorities, against the powers of this world's darkness, and against the spiritual forces of evil in the heavenly realms.

¹³ Therefore take up the full armor of God, so that when the day of evil comes, you will be able to stand your ground, and having done everything, to stand. ¹⁴ Stand firm then, with the belt of truth buckled around your waist, with the breastplate of righteousness arrayed, ¹⁵ and with your feet fitted with the readiness of the gospel of peace. ¹⁶ In addition to all this, take up the shield of faith, with which you can extinguish all the flaming arrows of the evil one. ¹⁷ And take the helmet of salvation and the sword of the Spirit, which is the word of God.

¹⁸ Pray in the Spirit at all times, with every kind of prayer and petition. To this end, stay alert with all perseverance in your prayers for all the saints. ¹⁹ Pray also for me, that whenever I open my mouth, words may be given me so that I will boldly make known the mystery of the gospel, ²⁰ for which I am an ambassador in chains. Pray that I may proclaim it fearlessly, as I should.